



Android Q might get iOS like gestures

Some hidden developer options in Android Q suggest that Google will make Android Q behave almost like an iPhone. <https://digit.in/apr19-69>



Windows defender on Browsers

Microsoft is testing Windows Defender extensions for both Chrome and Firefox to better protect PCs. <https://digit.in/apr19-70>

NZXT H500

Taking out the smart is smarter

While the NZXT H700i that we tested earlier was a mid-tower case, the H500 is a more compact version of it compromising on fan and radiator support. If you're wondering about the missing 'i' in the model name, then we should tell you that all these cases come in two variants where the non-i versions don't have the smart module installed. The H500 follows the same minimalist design approach and looks absolutely brilliant in the white variant. It also brings convenient cable management routes with Velcro straps, making the overall build process easier.

Build quality and design

On the exterior, NZXT has used steel panels all over. The ports on the top panel blend in well along with the tempered glass side panel. We liked the removal technique of the glass panel. The only area where we'll nitpick is that the quality of the thumbscrews could have been better. There are dust filters across the case where there's air intake or exhaust.

The insides are built well except the front panel fan mount. While the motherboard plate and PSU shroud were thick enough and couldn't bend easily, the fan mount could. Although it wasn't flimsy, the thinner gauge was surprising compared to the other internal parts. Having a fan mount is extremely convenient during fan or radiator installation.

Features

The cable management system in the new H series is brilliant. It takes care of all your cables with a generous amount of tie points all across the back of the motherboard plate. At the



Price
₹9,000



PERFORMANCE.....	85
FEATURES.....	59
BUILD QUALITY.....	71
VALUE.....	90

middle, there's a convenient cable routing channel to accommodate all the thick cables behind Velcro straps. Throughout the build process, because of these preexisting channels, we were able to plan the build better.

In terms of cooling capability, the maximum height of the radiator that you can install is 280mm on the front panel. You can install only one 120/140mm fan on the top panel. Another feature we want to highlight is the extremely useful IO port connector. But NZXT has bundled up the cables of the power and reset button into a single connector that can be attached like the USB connectors. This is something other case manufacturers should definitely adopt.

Thermal performance

Two Aer F120 Case Version fans are included in the package where each of them remove hot air out from the top and rear panel. Without any air intake, we expected the internal temperature to be slightly higher than average. However, that wasn't the case and the recorded temperatures were within the acceptable range. Before running

the stress tests, we let the system stay idle for 15 minutes. The Intel Core i7-4960X idled at 36 degrees Celsius and Radeon HD 7790 stabilised at 34 degrees Celsius.

In our Prime95 stress test, the CPU went up to 53 degrees while the GPU touched 69 degrees. For a better picture of how well the case performs with more fans, we installed two more 120mm fans on the front panel as intake. Surprisingly, it didn't do much at all. Installing a radiator in the future, for your CPU, would be a better investment rather than adding fans to cool the case. Additionally, replacing the top exhaust fan with a high airflow fan later will also lower the temperature inside by a few degrees.

At this price, the cooling performance of the case is way above average. You can rely on the case fans themselves to cool your system instead of replacing them with new ones.

Final thoughts

The NZXT H500 offers an impressive value for money considering its features, build quality and performance compared to the other cases we tested so far. You could go ahead with the H500i if you want to splurge on the smart module. However, the convenience and usefulness of the module aren't justified yet for the extra price. On online markets, you can spot the case for much lower than the MRP and that's where it becomes extremely competitive. With the beautiful cable management system behind the motherboard plate and the minimalist aesthetics, the H500 deserves to be spent time on to build a neat-looking rig.

—Abhijit Dey

SPECIFICATIONS

MOTHERBOARD FORM FACTOR: Mini-ITX, Micro-ATX, ATX | POWER SUPPLY STANDARD: ATX standard (max. length of 180mm) | I/O PORTS: 2x USB 3.1 Gen-1, 1x headphone/microphone combo | DRIVE BAYS: 3 x 3.5-inch HDD, 2 x 2.5-inch SSD | FAN SUPPORT: 2 x 120mm / 2 x 140mm (front), 1 x 120mm / 1 x 140mm (top), 1 x 120mm (rear) | RADIATOR SUPPORT: Up to 280mm (front), 120mm (rear) | CLEARANCES: CPU cooler - 165mm, Graphics card - 381mm | DIMENSIONS (H x W x D): 435mm x 210mm x 428mm

CONTACT

NZXT | PHONE: NA | EMAIL: support@nzxt.com | WEBSITE: www.nzxt.com